



HARVESTING

Parsnips can be harvested in the summer when young or left in the ground until the first frosts, which is said to improve flavor.

STORING

Spread moist sand in the bottom of a wooden box, and place a layer of parsnips on top, ensuring that they are not touching. Cover with sand and store in a cool, dry place. The sand will prevent the roots from shriveling or rotting. Alternatively, parsnips can be left in the ground until you need them. Cover with a layer of straw if the weather turns cold.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Parsnips are vulnerable to pests such as carrot fly and celery root miner. Female carrot flies lay eggs in the soil near to plants, which hatch and tunnel into the roots, rotting them. Use fine mesh to deter them (see carrots pp.184-5). There is no cure, so dig up affected roots. Celery leaf miner causes brown spots on leaves, but may not be fatal if prompt action is taken.

Diseases include parsnip canker and downy mildew. There is no cure for parsnip canker, which causes roots to rot, so choose resistant varieties.